

THE PORTAL MECHANIC

HubSpot Portal Teardown Checklist

A practical 45-minute self-audit to find the hidden issues making your CRM harder to trust, use, and scale.

**You do not need a new HubSpot.
You need the one you have to work.**

PORTAL / COMPANY

DATE

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START HERE

45 minutes

How to use this checklist

You are not trying to grade HubSpot as a product. You are testing whether your portal supports the way your business actually acquires, qualifies, sells to, and serves customers.

Score every check

2

Healthy

1

Needs work

0

Missing / unknown

01	Score honestly Give each check 2 for healthy, 1 for needs work, or 0 for missing / unknown. Unknown is a useful finding.
02	Capture evidence Write the record view, workflow, report, or example that proves your score. Avoid scoring by memory.
03	Fix by risk Prioritize items that affect revenue decisions, customer experience, data integrity, or many users.

Interpret your total

Add the six area scores for a maximum of 72. The total gives direction; the evidence behind each score tells you what to fix.

58-72	Reliable foundation	Protect what works and improve the few weak links.
40-57	Operational drag	Prioritize the red items that influence handoffs and reporting.
0-39	Trust is at risk	Stabilize definitions, ownership, and high-impact automation first.

Scope note

This is a practical operating review, not an exhaustive technical, security, or legal audit. Available controls vary by HubSpot subscription and portal configuration.

AREA 1 OF 6

Score 0 / 1 / 2

1. CRM foundation

Start here. If the data model is unclear, every workflow, report, and handoff built on top of it becomes harder to trust.

01. Core properties have clear definitions

Healthy: Teams agree what each required field means and when it should be populated.

Warning sign: The same field is interpreted differently by sales, marketing, and service.

0	1	2
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02. Required data is proportionate

Healthy: Only data needed for the next action is required; enrichment happens later.

Warning sign: Users enter placeholders just to save a record or move a deal.

0	1	2
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03. Duplicate control is routine

Healthy: Likely duplicates are reviewed on a schedule and imports use stable identifiers.

Warning sign: Contacts or companies are repeatedly merged by hand after reports break.

0	1	2
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04. Record ownership is dependable

Healthy: Active records have a responsible owner and reassignment rules cover departures.

Warning sign: Queues fill with unassigned records or former employees remain owners.

0	1	2
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05. Company association logic is understood

Healthy: Domains, parent-child relationships, and multi-company contacts are handled deliberately.

Warning sign: Activity or revenue is credited to the wrong account.

0	1	2
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06. Test and internal records are controlled

Healthy: Test data is labeled, excluded from reporting, and removed when no longer needed.

Warning sign: Dashboards include demos, employees, or integration test records.

0	1	2
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AREA SCORE

_____ / 12

AREA 2 OF 6

Score 0 / 1 / 2

2. Lifecycle and lead management

This section tests whether a new inquiry can become a qualified opportunity without relying on tribal knowledge.

07. Lifecycle stages describe real transitions

Healthy: Every stage has an owner, entry criteria, and a clear next stage.

Warning sign: Stages are used as labels rather than a controlled progression.

0	1	2
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08. Lead status supports daily follow-up

Healthy: Statuses tell a rep what has happened and what to do next.

Warning sign: Records sit in New, Open, or blank states with no next action.

0	1	2
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09. Qualification is explicit

Healthy: The team uses a small set of observable qualification criteria.

Warning sign: Qualified means different things depending on who updates the record.

0	1	2
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10. Source attribution is protected

Healthy: Original acquisition data is preserved while later touches are tracked separately.

Warning sign: Imports or workflows overwrite the first known source.

0	1	2
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11. Handoffs have an SLA

Healthy: Routing, acceptance, and follow-up expectations are measurable.

Warning sign: Marketing assumes sales followed up; sales never saw the lead.

0	1	2
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12. Recycling has a defined path

Healthy: Not-ready leads enter a nurture or review path without polluting active queues.

Warning sign: Closed or disqualified leads disappear forever or remain permanently active.

0	1	2
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AREA SCORE

_____ / 12

AREA 3 OF 6

Score 0 / 1 / 2

3. Sales pipeline

A healthy pipeline reflects buyer progress, not internal optimism. Test whether the same deal would be staged the same way by two different reps.

13. Deal stages are evidence-based

Healthy: Each stage requires an observable buyer action or agreed milestone.

Warning sign: Stages are based on probability, rep confidence, or elapsed time.

0	1	2
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14. Stage requirements match the process

Healthy: Critical fields are captured at the point they become knowable.

Warning sign: Required fields are bypassed, guessed, or completed at the end.

0	1	2
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15. Exit paths are specific

Healthy: Closed-lost reasons and disqualification details support useful analysis.

Warning sign: Most losses are marked Other, No response, or left blank.

0	1	2
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16. Next step discipline is visible

Healthy: Open deals have a dated next action and recent activity.

Warning sign: Pipeline reviews begin with asking reps what is happening.

0	1	2
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17. Stale deals are surfaced

Healthy: Age thresholds reflect normal cycle length and trigger review, not silent auto-closing.

Warning sign: Old deals inflate pipeline value and forecast confidence.

0	1	2
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18. Amount and close date are credible

Healthy: Values have a documented source and dates are updated when reality changes.

Warning sign: Month-end causes mass close-date pushing or unexplained amount changes.

0	1	2
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AREA SCORE

_____ / 12

AREA 4 OF 6

Score 0 / 1 / 2

4. Automation and integrations

Automation should remove reliable, repeatable work. It should not hide unclear ownership or make irreversible changes without safeguards.

19. Every active workflow has an owner

Healthy: Purpose, trigger, exclusions, and owner are documented in the workflow itself.

Warning sign: No one knows whether an old workflow is safe to turn off.

0	1	2
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20. Enrollment logic is narrow and testable

Healthy: Triggers use explicit criteria and suppress test, internal, and exception records.

Warning sign: Unexpected records enroll because filters are broad or ambiguous.

0	1	2
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21. Re-enrollment is intentional

Healthy: Repeated enrollment is enabled only where repeated action is actually desired.

Warning sign: Contacts receive duplicate tasks, emails, or property updates.

0	1	2
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22. High-impact actions have guardrails

Healthy: Deletes, ownership changes, stage moves, and notifications are reviewed carefully.

Warning sign: A single property change can rewrite large parts of the database.

0	1	2
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23. Integration ownership is assigned

Healthy: Each sync has a technical owner, business owner, source of truth, and failure path.

Warning sign: Sync errors accumulate because every team assumes another team owns them.

0	1	2
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24. Unused automation is retired safely

Healthy: History and dependencies are reviewed before deactivation; cleanup is recorded.

Warning sign: Workflow clutter makes change risky and troubleshooting slow.

0	1	2
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AREA SCORE

_____ / 12

AREA 5 OF 6

Score 0 / 1 / 2

5. Reporting and operating rhythm

A dashboard is useful only when its definitions are trusted and someone changes behavior because of it.

25. Key metrics have written definitions

Healthy: Scope, date logic, exclusions, and owner are visible next to the metric.

Warning sign: Two dashboards show different numbers with the same label.

0	1	2
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26. Reports use the right date field

Healthy: Create, stage, close, and activity dates are selected to answer the actual question.

Warning sign: Performance changes when someone silently switches date logic.

0	1	2
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27. Funnel reports reconcile

Healthy: Stage volumes can be traced back to records and explained by the process.

Warning sign: Conversion rates look plausible but cannot be reproduced.

0	1	2
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28. Dashboards serve a decision

Healthy: Every recurring dashboard supports an owner, cadence, and expected action.

Warning sign: Reports are admired in meetings but never change priorities.

0	1	2
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29. Exceptions are easy to find

Healthy: Operational views expose missing owners, stale deals, failed syncs, and incomplete handoffs.

Warning sign: Teams discover issues only after a customer or executive raises them.

0	1	2
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30. Data quality has a maintenance cadence

Healthy: A named owner reviews critical exceptions and trends at least monthly.

Warning sign: Cleanup happens only before a migration, audit, or leadership review.

0	1	2
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AREA SCORE

_____ / 12

AREA 6 OF 6

Score 0 / 1 / 2

6. Governance and user experience

A portal stays healthy when people can make the right change easily and risky changes are deliberate.

31. Permissions match responsibilities

Healthy: Users can do their jobs without broad administrative access.

Warning sign: Admin access is the default solution to every permissions problem.

0	1	2
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32. Naming conventions are consistent

Healthy: Lists, workflows, properties, reports, and campaigns are easy to search and sort.

Warning sign: Assets are named Final, New, Test, Copy, or by an employee's initials.

0	1	2
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33. Change ownership is visible

Healthy: Material changes have a requester, implementer, test evidence, and rollback plan.

Warning sign: Portal behavior changes without a reliable explanation.

0	1	2
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34. Views support each role

Healthy: Teams see the fields, queues, and saved views needed for their actual workflow.

Warning sign: Users export to spreadsheets because HubSpot feels slower than their workaround.

0	1	2
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35. Training reflects the configured portal

Healthy: Guidance uses the team's real stages, properties, and exceptions.

Warning sign: Generic product training leaves users guessing about local process.

0	1	2
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36. Archiving is part of maintenance

Healthy: Unused assets are reviewed, documented, and archived without breaking dependencies.

Warning sign: Search results are dominated by abandoned fields, lists, and reports.

0	1	2
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AREA SCORE

_____ / 12

YOUR DIAGNOSIS

Turn findings into work

Portal scorecard

Transfer each area score here. Circle the two areas with the highest operational risk, even if they are not the lowest scores.

1. CRM foundation	_____ / 12
2. Lifecycle and lead management	_____ / 12
3. Sales pipeline	_____ / 12
4. Automation and integrations	_____ / 12
5. Reporting and operating rhythm	_____ / 12
6. Governance and user experience	_____ / 12
TOTAL	_____ / 72

Your next five fixes

A useful priority is specific, evidence-backed, owned, and small enough to verify. Start with one fix that restores trust quickly.

1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

Your portal can be easier to trust.

The goal is not a perfectly tidy account. It is a system your team can understand, operate, and improve without fear.

Want a second opinion?

I help HubSpot teams identify the structural issues behind unreliable reporting, leaky handoffs, and automation no one trusts - then turn the findings into a practical repair plan.

BOOK A HUBSPOT HEALTH CHECK

richardtuharsky.com/#book

NOTES

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